FREE CHECKLIST

Our Agreed Words List

A one-sheet home and school agreement of the words everyone will use for body parts and privacy.

WHO IT IS FOR
Parents, carers, teachers and SNAs of autistic children and young people.

NCCA STAGE
Primary · Junior Cycle · Special classes

Easy read

At home and at school, we use the same words. The same words help me understand. I know what to say.

How to use this resource

- Parent and teacher fill in the table together, at a meeting or by email.
- Where home and school use different words, agree one set. Write the agreed word in the middle column.
- Both sign. Keep a copy at home and at school. Share with SNAs, support staff and respite carers.
- Review at the start of each school year, or when the child's needs change.
- Share the phrases with the child, using visuals if they help.

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Version 1.0 · agreed-words-list

Our word list

Fill in the last two columns. If both use the same word, write it in both. We recommend the correct anatomical names. These are suggested in the second column.

Body part	The word we use (suggested)	The word we use at home	The word school uses
Penis	penis		
Testicles	testicles		
Vulva	vulva		
Vagina	vagina		
Breasts	breasts		
Bottom	bottom		
Wee	wee or urine		
Poo	poo or faeces		
Period	period		
Erection	erection		
Wet dream	wet dream		
Toilet	toilet		

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Our shared phrases

Use exactly these words, every time, at home and at school. Say them in a calm, even voice.

When private behaviour happens in a public place

That's private. Bedroom or bathroom.

Teaching what private parts are

Underwear covers private parts.

When someone touches another person without asking

We ask first. We keep our hands to ourselves.

When a child asks a question at a public time

Good question. Let's talk about it in a private place.

If a child feels unsafe

You can say no. You can go away. You can tell a trusted adult.

If a child tells you something worrying

Thank you for telling me. I believe you. I will help.

Doors

Knock first. Wait for the answer.

Private parts and the doctor

The doctor can look at your body. A trusted adult is with you.

Why the same words matter

- Many autistic learners take words literally. A new word for the same thing can sound like a different thing.
- Predictable language helps a child learn a rule once and use it everywhere.
- Mixed messages cause worry and confusion about what is allowed.
- Clear, correct names help a child tell an adult exactly what happened if something is wrong.

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- The same words at home, school, respite and clubs keep a child safe in every place.

Notes for adults

- Agree the words **before** a situation arises, not during one.
- Use the same tone as well as the same words: calm, neutral and without shame.
- Avoid nicknames and euphemisms. The aim is clear words, not rude or silly ones.
- Respect the family's culture and values. Agree words that everyone can use comfortably. Keep the child's safety first.
- Make a visual card with the key phrases for the child to carry or keep on the wall.

Agreed and signed

Parent or carer

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Teacher or SNA

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Child's name and class

Child: _____

Class or year: _____

Review date: _____

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Curriculum links

NCCA and Department of Education alignment

- Primary SPHE (1999), strand **Myself**, strand unit *Taking care of my body* and *Safety and protection*; Stay Safe programme.
- Junior Cycle SPHE (2023), Strand 3 **Relationships and Sexuality**: using respectful, correct language.
- NCCA guidance on RSE for students with special educational needs: consistent language and partnership between home and school.

Universal Design for Learning

Every Autism & Me resource offers more than one way in: pictures and words together, an easy-read line, things to do with your hands, and scripts to practise. Keep the learning aim the same for everyone, and change the route. No diagnosis is needed to use any support in this resource.

Getting support in Ireland

Your school

Talk to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP) for child safeguarding, a class tutor or year head.

Parentline

Support for parents and carers: 01 873 3500, parentline.ie.

Tusla – Child and Family Agency

Report a worry about a child's safety to your local Tusla social work duty team. Contacts at tusla.ie.

Childline (ISPCC)

Free, 24 hours: phone 1800 66 66 66, text 50101, or chat at childline.ie. For anyone under 18.

Your GP or public health nurse

For questions about puberty, periods, body changes or health checks.

Autism & Me

Questions about this resource or training for your school: contactautismandme@gmail.com · autismandme.ie

If a child tells you something worrying

Stay calm. Listen, and believe them. Do not promise to keep it a secret. Write down what they said in their own words, with the date. Pass it on the same day: in a school, to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP); otherwise to Tusla. If anyone is in immediate danger, call 112 or 999. Follow *Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children* (2017).

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